Agenda – Day 1: Mapping the Present

Charting the course: exploring the past, present, and future of AMD

Arrival & breakfast – 08:00 AM

The great voyage of AMD

Opening remarks — 8:30 AM
Heather Blankenship, PhD | MDHHS

An evolution of AMD in public health labs — 9:30 AM
Christin Hanigan, PhD | Association of Public Health Laboratories

Morning refreshment break – 10:15 AM

Genomic journeys: case studies from the field — 10:30 AM

Moderator – Madison Walton-Franklin, PhD | MDHHS

Genomic & epidemiological investigation of an invasive meningococcal disease outbreak in Chicago, 2026 — 10:35 AM
Camden Gowler, PhD | Chicago Department of Public Health

Utilizing genomic sequencing to identify an invasive Group A *Streptococcus* cluster in a memory care facility — 10:55 AM
Frida Salgado, MS, MPH | Nebraska Department of Health and Human Services

Hepatitis C genomic surveillance with GHOST system: findings and lessons learned — 11:15 AM
Jie He, PhD, MPH | Wisconsin Department of Health Services

Applying whole genome sequencing to invasive Group A *Streptococcus* outbreak investigations in congregate settings — 11:35 AM
Karrie-Ann Toews, MPH | Chicago Department of Public Health

Cyclospora case investigation and epidemiologic findings in Michigan, June–September 2026 — 11:55 AM
Katie Arends, MPH & Ivy Earl, MPH | MDHHS

Lunch break – 12:15 PM

Agenda – Day 1: Mapping the Present

Charting the course: exploring the past, present, and future of AMD

Diving in: concurrent breakout sessions — 01:15 PM

Streamlining sequencing: practical automation for public health laboratories

Elizabeth Burgess, MS, Terry Furton, Macy Sevic, PhD, Kourtney Wells, MB (ASCP) CM, & Ellie Yoon, MS | MDHHS

Smooth sailing with Nextflow: pipelines, containers, and real-world troubleshooting

John Chodkowski, PhD, Douglas Maldonado-Torres, MS, & Karla Vasco, DVM, PhD, MSc | MDHHS

Setting the compass: prioritizing specimens for sequencing with purpose

Madison Walton-Franklin, PhD, Azam Ali Sher, DVM, PhD, MPH, & Ivy Earl, MPH | MDHHS

Afternoon refreshment break – 03:00 PM

Adventures in collaboration: cross-silo liaison panel — 03:15 PM

Moderator: Macy Sevic, PhD | MDHHS

Ryli Hockensmith, MPH | Laboratory-Epidemiology Connector
Kentucky Department for Public Health

Mary Jewell, MS | Genomic Epidemiologist
Utah Department of Health & Human Services

Karim Morey, MS, M(ASCP) | AMD Lead Microbiologist III
Oregon State Public Health Laboratory

Mark Sewell, MS | Project Manager, IT Systems & Infrastructure
Kentucky Department for Public Health

Day 1 recap & conclusions — 04:20 PM

Evening networking social (optional) | 5:30–7:30pm

Agenda – Day 2: Navigating the Future

Charting the course: exploring the past, present, and future of AMD

Arrival & breakfast – 08:00 AM

Building tomorrow's harbor

Setting sail in genomic epidemiology — 08:30 AM
Heather Blankenship, PhD & Arianna Miles-Jay, PhD, MPH | MDHHS

Future proofing AMD programs: group discussion — 09:00 AM
Macy Sevic, PhD & Madison Walton-Franklin, PhD | MDHHS

Morning refreshment break – 09:45 AM

All hands on deck: collaborative tabletop exercise — 10:00 AM

Arianna Miles-Jay, PhD, MPH, Douglas Maldonado-Torres, MS, Sara McNamara MPH, MLS(ASCP), CIC, & Becky Kramer, BS | MDHHS

Lunch break – 12:00PM

Tools for the next journey

AMD Platform

Moderator: Madison Walton-Franklin, PhD | MDHHS

Overview & demonstration — 01:00 PM
David Jones, PhD | CDC

AMD Platform Q&A session — 01:30 PM
David Jones, PhD | CDC



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Agenda – Day 2: Navigating the Future

Charting the course: exploring the past, present, and future of AMD

Afternoon refreshment break – 2:15 PM

Tools for the next journey – continued

Expanding the AMD toolkit — 02:30 PM
Moderator: Macy Sevic, PhD | MDHHS

Citywide respiratory virus surveillance via indoor air sampling — 02:35 PM
Hannah Barbian, PhD | Rush University Medical Center

Double duty—dual validations of tiled-amplicon and hybrid-capture approaches for SARS-CoV-2 — 02:50 PM
Kris Gilbert, PhD | Kentucky Department for Public Health

Leveraging the MAAGE genomic surveillance platform to trace and investigate a *Serratia marcescens* HAI cluster — 03:05 PM
Charles Williams, MPH | Illinois Department of Public Health
Maulik Shukla, MS | Argonne National Laboratory

Creating a framework for advancing outbreak analytics: development of a decision tree for genomic epidemiology visualization tool selection — 03:20 PM
Jenny Crain, MS, MPH, CPH | Virginia Department of Health

Plotting your next coordinates — 03:30 PM

Feedback & evaluations
Macy Sevic, PhD | MDHHS

Closing remarks
Heather Blankenship, PhD & Arianna Miles-Jay, PhD, MPH | MDHHS

Event concludes – 4:00 PM